

Ed Lopat To Join Yankees

By ANDY McCUTCHEON

Manager Eddie Lopat has been released from his contract, the Virginians said today, to accept another job.

That job will be as an organization pitching coach with the Yankees, according to a report last night out of New York.

The Virginians released their manager of three seasons yesterday but a formal announcement of his new post is not expected until tomorrow.

Lopat's departure—predicted in mid-season and reported as fact later—leaves the Virginians' managerial derby wide open.

The Yankees are expected to exercise their option to buy the local International League club, but from all indications they'll have to go outside the system for their triple-A manager.

Aaron Lanier, comptroller of the Yankees, may be in tonight or tomorrow to begin a study of the proposed purchase. He will check the Virginians' books and discuss a lease for the use of Parker Field with Greater Richmond Civic Recreation, Inc.

"I'd be lost even trying to guess the identity of the next manager," Virginians general manager Herman Krattenmaker said today.

Mayo Smith, fired this sea-



EDDIE LOPAT
Returns to Yankees

son by the Philadelphia Phillies, had the inside track—and was interested in the offer—until he accepted the job of managing the Cincinnati Reds.

There are few candidates from the farm system, Charley Silvers, the former Yankee catcher, didn't last the past season at New Orleans of the Southern Association in his first try as manager.

Denver, on its way out of the chain, had Andy Cohen all season but he wasn't a Yankee man, although Yankee approved. And at the end of the season he was released by the Bears.

At the next level in the system is Steve Souchock, the former first baseman who managed at Binghamton, N. Y., in the Eastern League and is now directing the Yankees' club in the Florida winter league for young prospects.

SLAUGHTER MENTIONED

From the playing ranks, most of the speculation has centered on Enos Slaughter, the aging Yankee outfielder, but the current owners—prior to the sale talk—had expressed a preference for a man with managerial experience.

In his new job Lopat will make the rounds in the Yankee system to work with the club's pitching prospects. He also will do some scouting—both of prospects and the opposition.

In the former left-handed pitcher's three seasons here, the Virginians finished sixth, third and, last season, sixth again. He pitched in 1956 but served only as manager the last two seasons.